

Computer Acceptable Use Policy

Sanitized public release

Document status	Public release template
Applies to	Personnel and authorized users of [Organization] information resources
Owner / approval	[Appropriate organizational authority]

Publication note: This edition preserves the policy intent while replacing organizational names with neutral placeholders and omitting internal identifiers, approval dates, revision history, contact paths, control timings, product names, and implementation-specific details.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes acceptable-use requirements for computing equipment, networks, applications, and information made available by [Organization]. It is intended to reduce cybersecurity, operational, legal, and reputational risk while supporting appropriate business use.

2. Scope and applicability

This policy applies to employees, contractors, temporary personnel, vendors, and other authorized users who access [Organization] information, systems, applications, devices, or networks. Access is conditioned on understanding and complying with this policy.

3. Policy requirements

3.1 General use and ownership

- Sensitive information and resources must be protected according to their classification and applicable handling requirements.
- Use of organizational systems may be logged, monitored, and reviewed as permitted by law and organizational policy.
- Limited incidental personal use may be allowed when it does not interfere with work, consume unreasonable resources, create risk, or violate policy or law.
- Only authorized and managed systems, applications, and devices may connect to organizational networks or process organizational information.
- Information created, stored, sent, or received using organizational resources remains subject to organizational ownership, access, retention, and disclosure requirements.

3.2 Accounts and security controls

- Accounts are assigned to individuals and must not be shared unless an approved technical or business process explicitly permits it.
- Users are responsible for activity performed with their credentials and must protect authentication information from unauthorized disclosure.
- Users must not disable, alter, evade, or interfere with security, monitoring, logging, filtering, encryption, or configuration controls.
- Users must secure unattended devices by locking the screen or signing out and must follow approved session-security settings.

- Public statements made using an organizational account must be authorized or clearly identified as personal views when appropriate.

3.3 Prohibited activities

- Using organizational resources for unlawful activity or to violate intellectual-property, privacy, export-control, or other legal obligations.
- Installing or distributing unlicensed, unauthorized, or malicious software or content.
- Attempting unauthorized access; intercepting data not intended for the user; circumventing authentication; scanning, disrupting, or degrading systems or communications without written authorization.
- Using scripts, commands, messages, or other means to interfere with another user or service.
- Using organizational resources for unauthorized commercial activity, warranties, offers, or representations.
- Disclosing personnel lists, sensitive information, or internal data to external parties without authorization.

4. Reporting

Suspected compromise, policy violations, accidental disclosure, lost devices, or unusual system behavior must be reported promptly through the organization's published security or support channel.

5. Enforcement and exceptions

Violations may result in restriction or revocation of access, corrective or disciplinary action, contractual remedies, and referral to appropriate authorities. Exceptions must be documented, justified by a business need, approved by designated authorities, limited in scope and duration, and periodically reviewed.

6. Definitions

Organizational resource: Any device, application, network, account, service, or information owned, managed, or provided by [Organization].

Sensitive information: Information requiring protection from unauthorized access, use, disclosure, alteration, or destruction.

Authorized user: A person granted access for an approved purpose and subject to applicable policies and agreements.